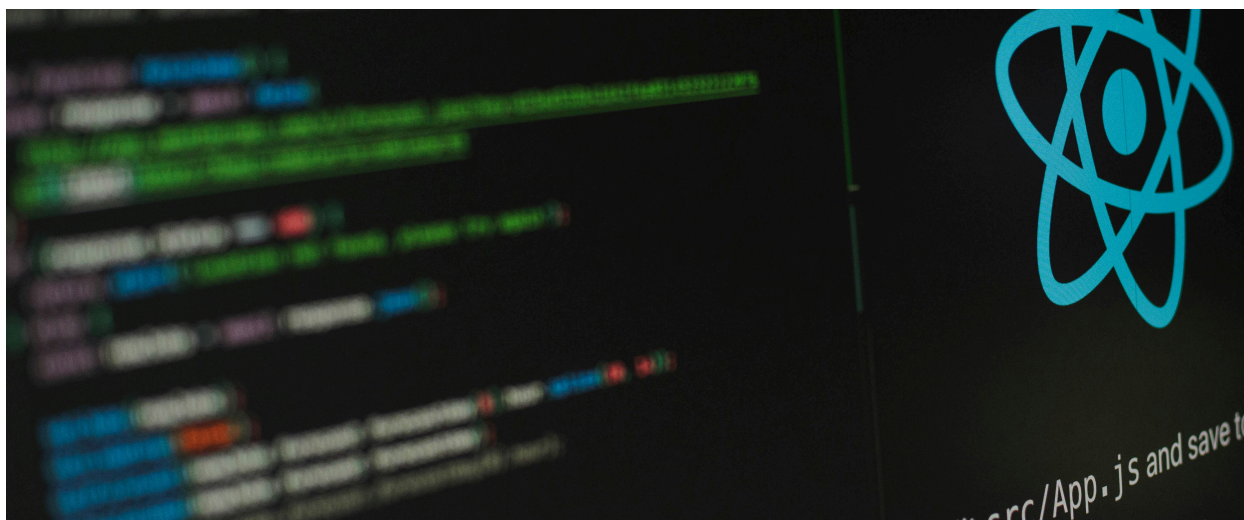




SEIM

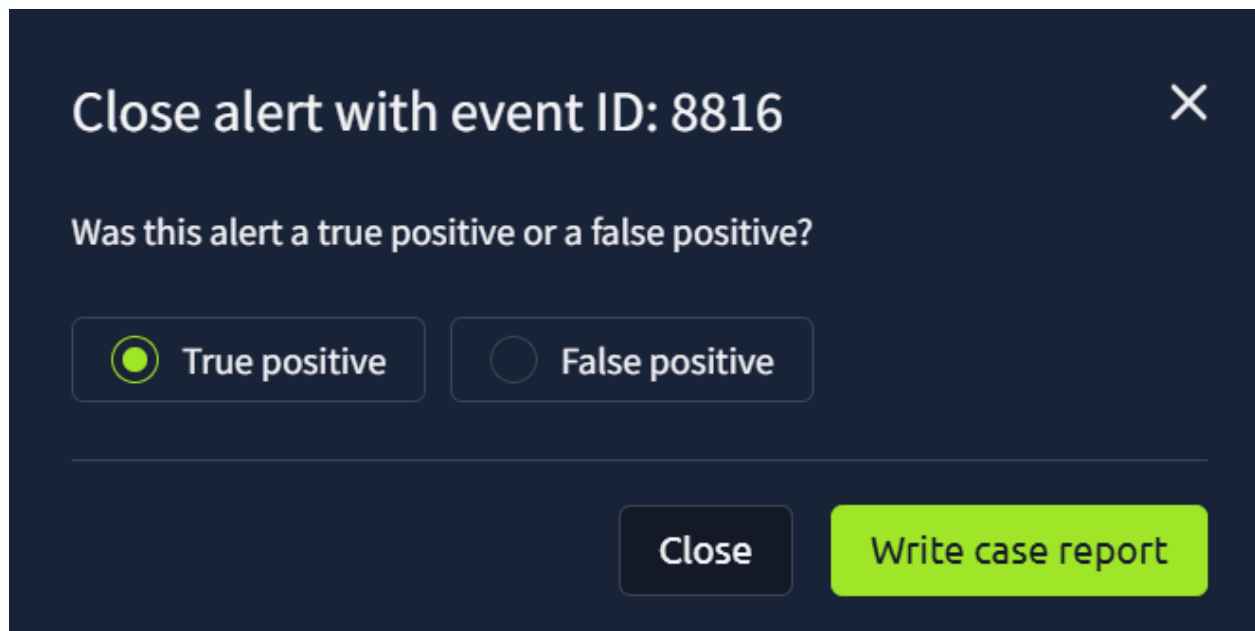
SOC Simulation (TryHackMe)

Practiced triaging security alerts in a simulated SOC environment – classifying alerts as true/false positives, assigning them for handling, and documenting findings in case reports for L2 escalation.

The screenshot shows the 'Alert queue' interface in the TryHackMe SOC Simulation. The interface has a dark theme and a sidebar on the left with navigation links: Dashboard, Alert queue (active), SIEM, TryDetectThis, Analyst VM, Documentation, Playbooks, and Case reports. The main area displays an 'Alert queue' with a progress bar indicating '0 alerts incoming'. Below this, there is a section for 'Assigned alert(s)' with a 'Write case report' button. A table of alerts is shown with columns: ID, Alert rule, Severity, Type, Date, Status, and Action. The table contains four alerts, all of which are 'Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link' with a 'Medium' severity and 'Phishing' type. The status for all alerts is 'Awaiting action'.

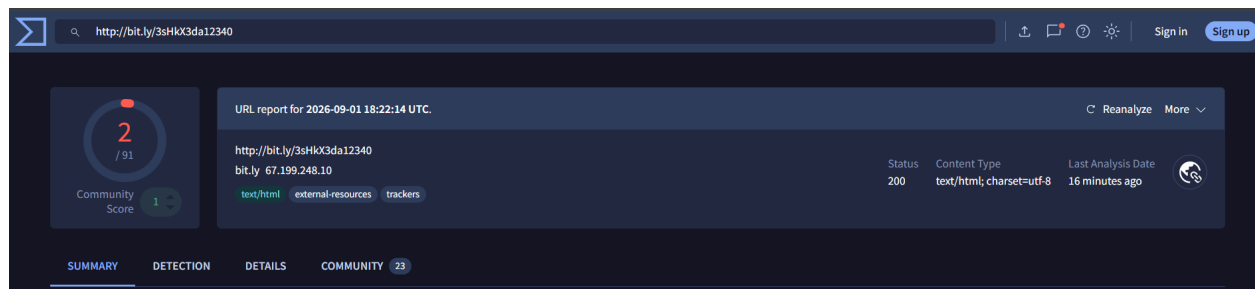
ID	Alert rule	Severity	Type	Date	Status	Action
8816	Access to Blacklisted External URL Blocked by Firewall	High	Firewall	Sep 1st 2026 at 18:50		
8818	Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link	Medium	Phishing	Sep 1st 2026 at 18:52	Awaiting action	
8817	Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link	Medium	Phishing	Sep 1st 2026 at 18:52	Awaiting action	
8815	Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link	Medium	Phishing	Sep 1st 2026 at 18:49	Awaiting action	
8814	Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link	Medium	Phishing	Sep 1st 2026 at 18:46	Awaiting action	

I assigned these alerts as **True Positive**, since they involved phishing tactics using a malicious URL.



A dark-themed modal dialog box with a close button (X) in the top right corner. The title is "Close alert with event ID: 8816". Below the title is the question "Was this alert a true positive or a false positive?". There are two radio button options: "True positive" (which is selected) and "False positive". At the bottom right, there are two buttons: "Close" and "Write case report" (which is highlighted in green).

The alert severity was **High** on the dashboard, so it was important to prioritize this alert as it appeared to be a real attack. As an L1 SOC analyst, the first step was to check the URL using an analysis tool, referencing the MITRE ATT&CK framework for context.



A screenshot of a web application interface for URL analysis. The browser address bar shows "http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340". The page has a dark theme and includes a search bar, "Sign in", and "Sign up" links. The main content area displays a "URL report for 2026-09-01 18:22:14 UTC." with a "Reanalyze" button and a dropdown menu. On the left, there is a "Community Score" section showing a score of 2 out of 91. The main report area shows the URL "http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340" and its IP address "bit.ly 67.199.248.10". Below this, there are tags for "text/html", "external-resources", and "trackers". To the right, a table shows the "Status" as 200, "Content Type" as "text/html; charset=utf-8", and "Last Analysis Date" as "16 minutes ago". At the bottom, there is a navigation bar with tabs for "SUMMARY", "DETECTION", "DETAILS", and "COMMUNITY (23)".



Warning: This URL is no longer available because it was created by a suspended account.

We recommend you close your browser window and notify the person who sent you the link.



Why was this link blocked?

The account used to create this link has been suspended for violations of our [Acceptable Use Policy](#). Links created by suspended accounts are suspended as well.

Learn more about what Bitly does to keep you safe at the [Bitly Trust Center](#).

If this is your link and believe your account has been suspended in error, submit an appeal via this [this form](#).

Redirection Chain ⓘ

`http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340`
↳ `https://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340`

URL Overview

Vendors Analysis:

🚫 2/91 security vendors flagged this URL as malicious

Final URL:

`https://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340`

Domain:

bit.ly

Serving IP:

67.199.248.10 🇺🇸 UNITED STATES

Current Status Code:

200

Category:

URL Redirect (alphaMountain.ai) computersandsoftware information technology web hosting marketing & merchandising technology

Tags:

trackers external-resources

After assigning the alert to myself, I analyzed it and wrote a case report explaining the alert triage details for the L2 analyst to continue further investigation.



Dashboard

Alert queue

SIEM

TryDetectThis

Analyst VM

Documentation

Playbooks

Case reports

← Case report for event ID: 8816

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
8816	Access to Blacklisted External URL Blocked by Firewall	This alert was triggered when a user attempted to access an external URL that is listed in the organization's blacklist or threat intelligence feeds. The firewall or proxy successfully blocked the outbound request, preventing the connection. Note: The blacklist only covers known threats. It does not guarantee protection against new or unknown malicious domains.	Firewall	High	Sep 1st 2026 at 22:51

Alert details ^

datasource: firewall



Dashboard

Alert queue

SIEM

TryDetectThis

Analyst VM

Documentation

Playbooks

Case reports

Alert details ^

datasource: firewall

timestamp: 09/01/2026 18:48:59.364

Action: blocked

SourceIP: 10.20.2.17

SourcePort: 34257

DestinationIP: 67.199.248.11

DestinationPort: 80

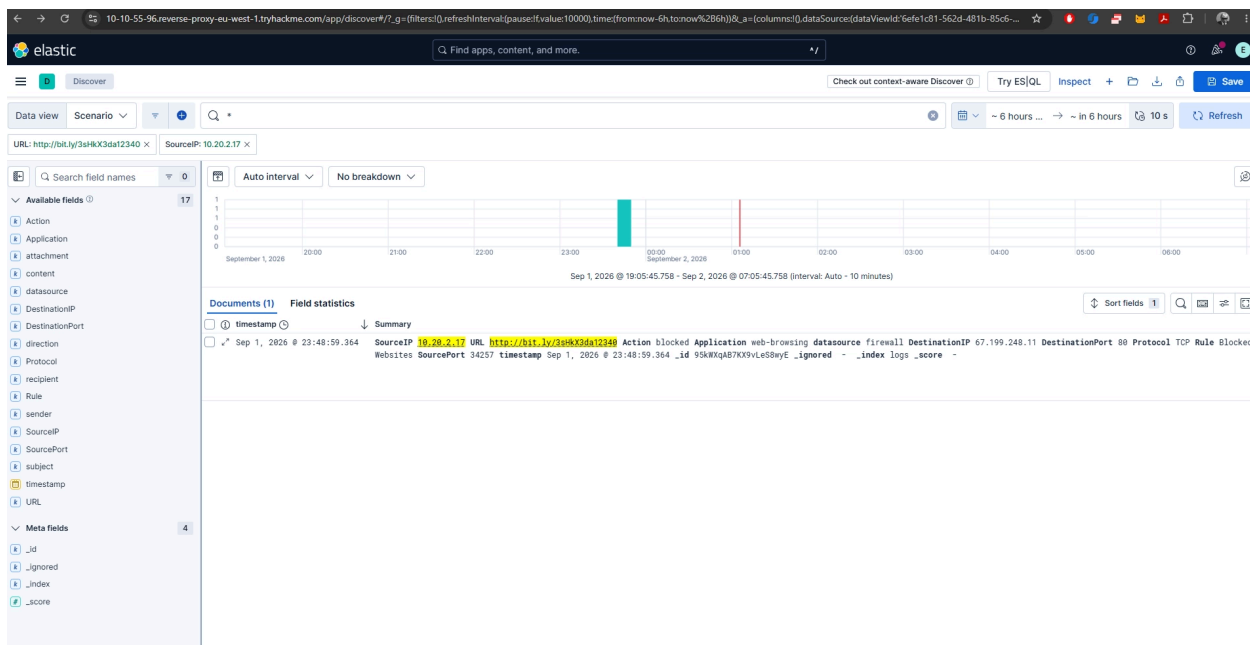
URL: http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340

Application: web-browsing

Protocol: TCP

Rule: Blocked Websites

I used the SIEM tool (Kibana Discover) to investigate in depth. In this screenshot, I investigated the repeated IP address and the repeated requests sent by the attacker. In this scenario, I looked at the malicious source IP that was blocked by the firewall due to the rules set in place.

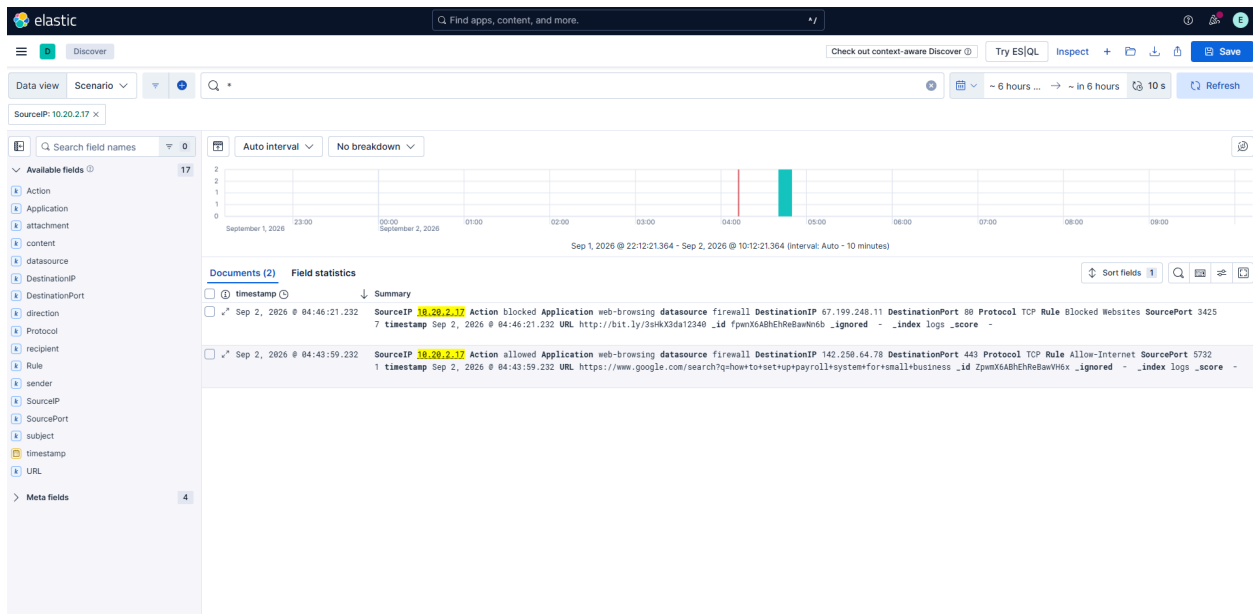


- **Log 1 (blocked, port 80):** a `bit.ly` shortened link → this is what triggered the block, since shortened/obfuscated URLs are commonly used to hide phishing destinations, and it was likely already listed in threat intel/blacklist feeds.
- **Log 2 (allowed, port 443):** a direct `google.com` search query about payroll systems → clean, legitimate traffic, unrelated to the blocked request.

The same internal source IP generated two separate requests. One was a shortened `bit.ly` link on port 80, which the firewall blocked as it matched a known-malicious/blacklisted URL. The other was a legitimate Google search on port 443, related to payroll system research, which was correctly allowed. This shows the value of correlating multiple log entries from the same host to distinguish malicious activity from normal user behavior.

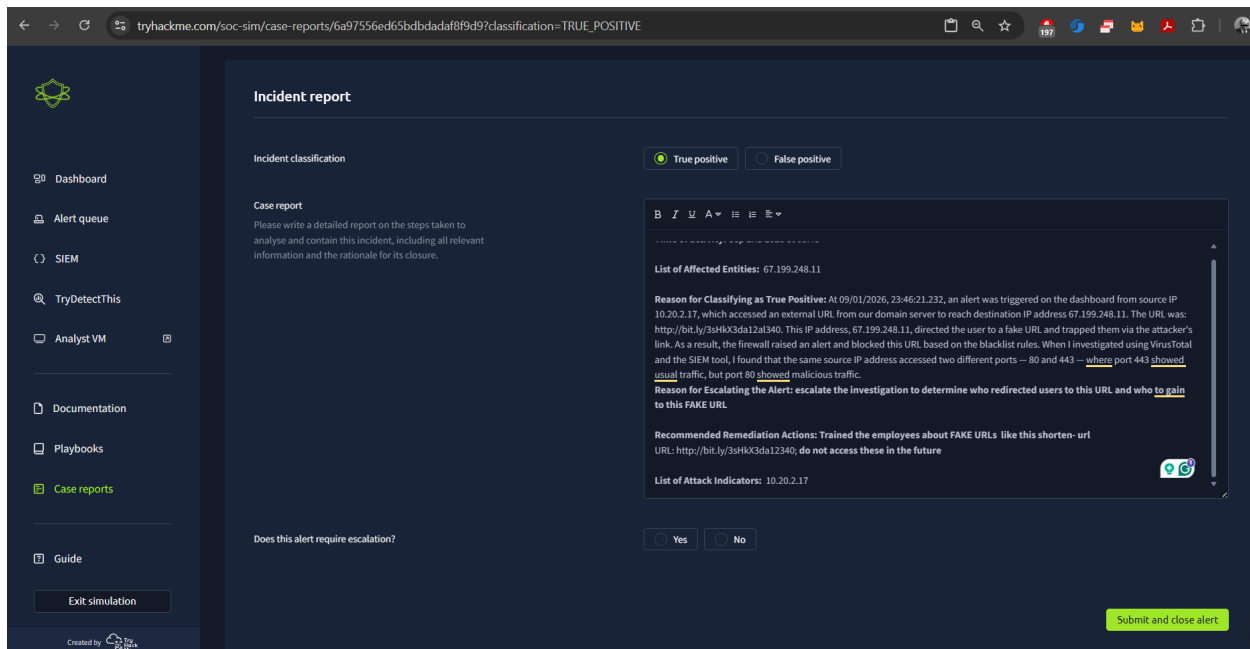
That's why I'm doing a deeper investigation in the Elastic Stack (SIEM), because sometimes I need to look at the attacker's tactics, or check whether an employee accessed a fake attacker link while browsing what appeared to be a normal URL. Sometimes

attackers leave a trap on a duplicate website – the employee believes it's the real site, but in the backend they get redirected to the attacker's webpage. That's why the firewall blocked the malicious URL on port 80, while port 443 was allowed as normal traffic, depending on the rule set in each case.

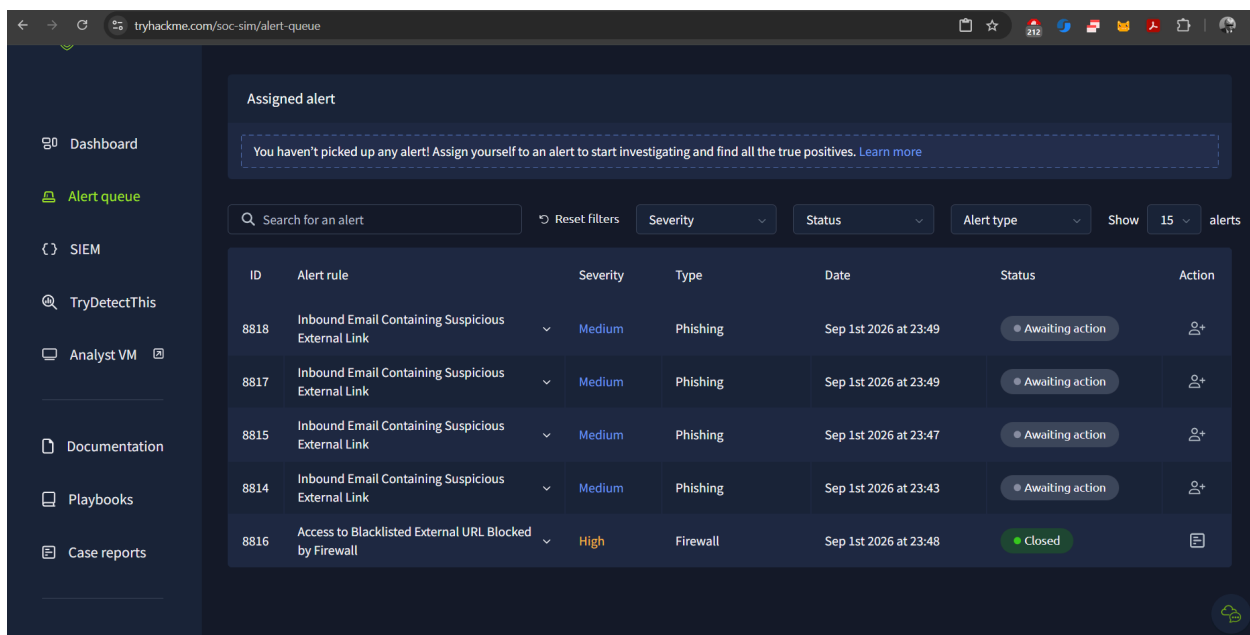


Escalation Report – Alert ID: 8816

The screenshot shows the 'Incident report' form in the tryhackme simulation environment. The form is titled 'Incident report' and includes sections for 'Incident classification', 'Case report', and 'Does this alert require escalation?'. The 'Case report' section contains a detailed description of the incident, including the time of activity, list of affected entities, reason for classifying as a true positive, and recommended remediation actions. The 'Does this alert require escalation?' section has radio buttons for 'Yes' and 'No'. A 'Submit and close alert' button is at the bottom right.



After completing the investigation, I closed the alert as SOC Analyst L1.



From all of this, what I learned is how to investigate logs, how to assign an alert to myself, and how to write a case report for L2 for further investigation. I also learned how to check whether an alert is a real alarm or a false alarm, and determine if it's

a false positive or true positive. I investigated this using Discover in Kibana (Elastic Stack) for log analysis, and after the investigation, I found it to be a true positive and closed the alert accordingly, as shown in the screenshots above. All of this – including the Elastic Stack – was provided by the TryHackMe platform, where I got hands-on practice for the SOC Analyst L1 role.